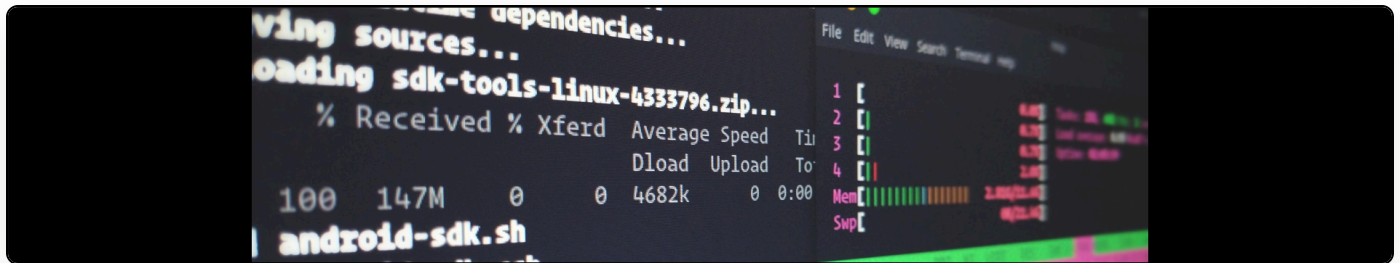


# SSH Key Based, Password Less Login

Cite as: Martin Paul Eve, "SSH Key Based, Password Less Login", *eve.gd: Martin Paul Eve*, December 07, 2008, <https://doi.org/10.59348/4s7eb-h5240>.

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It can be very handy to be able to login to an SSH shell without supplying a password. Here's how.

Firstly, on your client machine, generate a keypair. If you are using Windows you can do this using PuTTYgen. If you are on a Nix machine issue:

```
ssh-keygen -t dsa
```

Next up, we need to copy the public key to the server. If you are on Linux you can use scp to do this:

```
cd .ssh/  
scp id_dsa.pub server_user_name@server.address:./id_dsa.pub
```

If you are on Windows you could use sftp or similar to transfer the key across. You should end up with a file called id\_dsa.pub in your home directory on the server.

Now, on the server, with your regular user account:

```
cd .ssh  
touch authorized_keys2  
chmod 600 authorized_keys2  
cat ../id_dsa.pub >> authorized_keys2  
rm ../id_dsa.pub
```

Now, on Windows fire up a PuTTY session specifying the private key under SSH -> Auth. On Nix, simply give:

```
ssh -l server_user_name server.address
```

With any luck, you will be sorted for password-less login!